

risk and of women to be mindful and have a scarcity mindset is damaging to what young women expect their relationship with money to look like.

The visual content in articles about money pushes this narrative further. In 2021, social representation expert Professor Shireen Kanji at Brunel University audited image libraries to explore how women were being displayed. The results were not surprising: finance articles targeting women showed photos of women smiling next to a piggy bank, displaying a childlike concept of money. In fact, women were nearly four times as likely to be depicted like children compared to men. Yet men were shown in suits, making financial deals or having multiple screens in front of them. Men were more likely to be shown holding notes, while women were more likely to be pictured with pennies in their hands. In couple photos, which were largely of cisgender heterosexual white couples, women were shown to be watching as the man handled the finances. There was also an overall lack of diversity, again pushing the outdated, classist stereotypes surrounding money. These depictions really do matter; how we see people around us can negatively affect what we believe we are capable of.

I ran into this myself on a live TV interview. As I was speaking about breaking down the barriers to investing for women, the network chose to use images of men in suits and overcomplicated graphs as B roll visuals. I'm sure it wasn't intentional, but the irony of using those images to illustrate what I was speaking about was telling.

At a surface level, this may not seem like a big deal. But after years and years of consuming content that subtly tells you money is too hard to grasp, you start to believe that investing is complicated and only for men, while women are just inherently bad with money, or, worse, we're just not interested in our financial futures.

There is very little female representation within the world of investing itself. In 2016 in the US, only 11 per cent of decision-makers in venture capital were women, according to the 2016 NVCA Deloitte Human Capital Survey. Only 14 per cent of mutual fund managers globally are women, according to the 2021 Morningstar analysis of global fund managers. And in the US, only 31 per cent of financial advisers are women according to 2021 US Bureau of Labor statistics. That same study shows that in only 2